DESIGN THINKING

Enhancing Parents' Experience at IIIT Hyderabad

PROTOTYPE LINK POSTER LINK VIDEO LINK

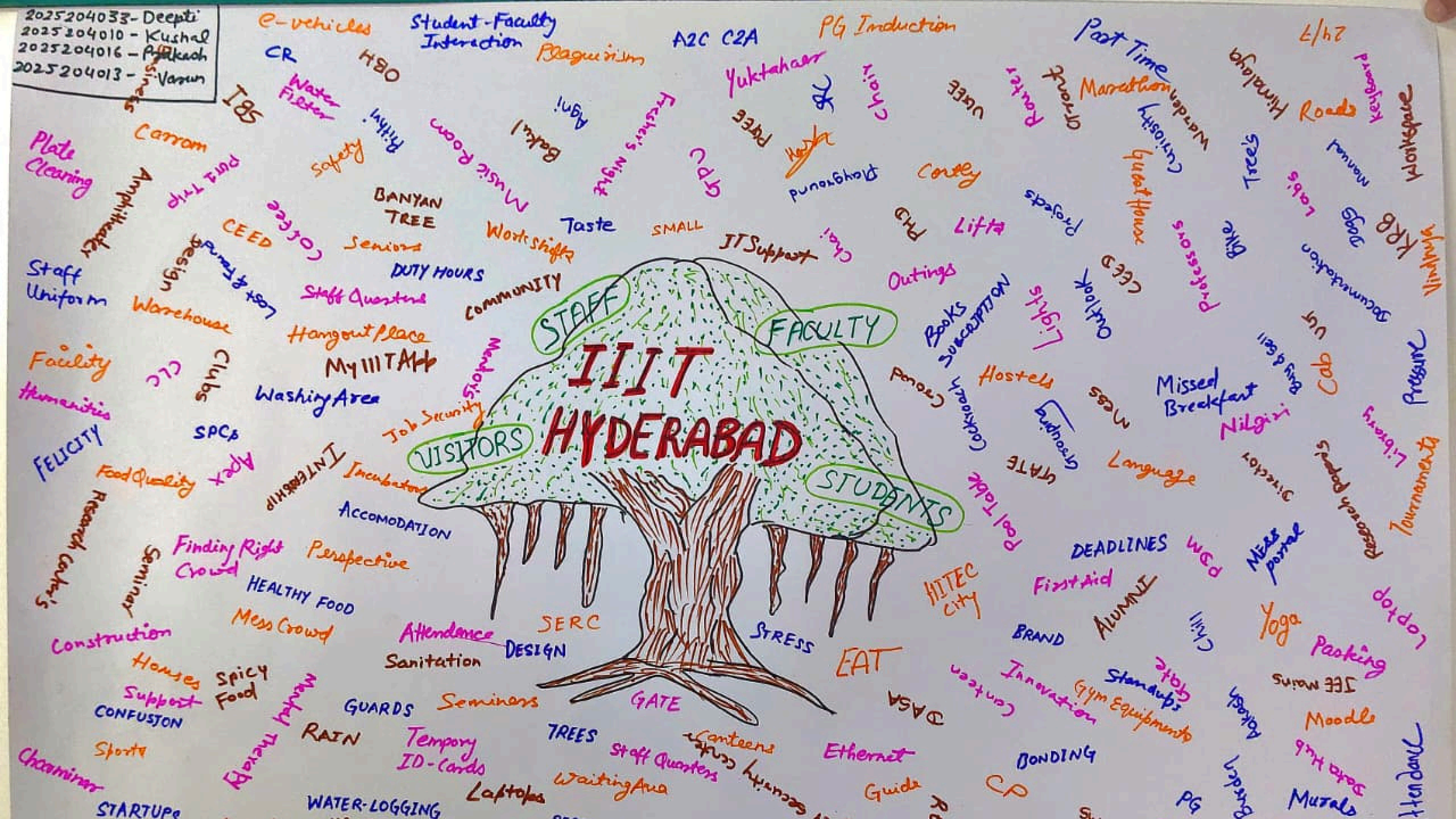
Initial Design Challenge

“How might we design meaningful, seamless, and inclusive experiences for all stakeholders at IIIT Hyderabad - including students, faculty, staff, institute management, parents, and visitors - to foster a stronger sense of participation, and operational efficiency?”

Brainstorming (LINK)

At the very beginning of the project, we conducted an open-ended brainstorming session to understand the **broad landscape of IIIT Hyderabad's ecosystem**.
Our goal was to **map out all the key themes, user groups, and touchpoints** that shape the overall IIIT-H experience.

2025204033 - Deepti
2025204010 - Kushal
2025204016 - Ashkash
2025204013 - Varun



Affinity Mapping

(LINK)

Our Stakeholder: VISITORS

We brainstormed different categories of visitors:

1. Parents and Guardians
2. Vendors- Delivery personnel/ Transport cabs
3. Media and Press
4. Collaborating Institutes
5. Other college Students
6. CIE/ IHub
7. Guest Lecturers/ Seminar Guets
8. NGOs/ Camps/ Government Authorities
9. Performers- Events/ Fests/ Sports
10. Placement Recruiters
11. Alumni

Phase 1: Discover & Validate

SECONDARY RESEARCH

- News articles about IIIT Hyderabad events and initiatives (e.g., AI courses, GreenTech incubators, research collaborations) to understand the types of visitors the institute attracts.
- Visitor experience descriptions from blogs and reviews, providing general sentiments about campus life, facilities, and culture
- Comparative analysis of visitor experiences at similar premier institutions like ISB Hyderabad and IIT Hyderabad to establish benchmarks

GENERIC STAKEHOLDER MAP

1 Use case

Define the use case.

- Participating in academic activities and cultural fests
- Recruitment process
- Parental visit during convocation, admission and personal meetings
- Alumni interactions, reunions and mentoring
- Collaborations with research labs and government authorities
- Vendors delivering goods and services
- Campus visit and exploration
- Authorities for approval & Inspection
- NGOs Camps/Volunteering

2 Stakeholders

Identify all stakeholders

- Security Guards
- Receptionist
- Event Organizers
- Apex Members
- Placement Cell
- Delivery handlers
- Students/Faculties
- Transport Services
- Hotels
- Media & Press
- Tech Support
- Facility Manager
- Maintainance / Housekeeping
- Hospitality & caterers
- Collaborating Institute
- Guest House

3 Create the map

Place the stakeholders in the map

4 Relationships

Draw the appropriate relationships.

- *relation*
- *Unclear, informal relationship*
- *Institutional Relationship*
- *Directed flow of information*
- *Relationship with conflict potential*
- *Interrupted relationship*

5 Findings

Describe your findings from the Stakeholder Map.

- Most stakeholders are case-specific, but guards, reception, and some students are consistently active.
- Some visitor journeys are well-structured, others are unorganized.
- During events, coordination between stakeholders might be missing.
- Stakeholders don't always know who else is involved in a visitor's journey.
- Conflicts might occur when visitors needs clash with rules

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DESIGN THINKING

INSIGHT RECEIVED

“PARENTS ARE THE ONLY VISITOR GROUP WHO REPEATEDLY ENGAGE WITH ALMOST EVERY STAKEHOLDER — GUARDS, RECEPTION, STUDENTS, MESS, ADMIN — YET RECEIVE LESS STRUCTURED SUPPORT.”

PHASE 2: DEEP DIVE

To Validate our assumption, we decided to conduct telephonic interview with the parents

Primary Research: Telephonic Interview

RESEARCH OBJECTIVE- To conduct open-ended, empathetic telephonic interviews with parents who visited IIIT-Hyderabad, in order to deeply understand their needs, motivations, expectations, emotional experiences, and friction points during their campus visit.

- Within one week, we conducted and analysed 8 open-ended telephonic interviews with parents who visited IIIT-Hyderabad.
- We intentionally did NOT investigate predefined problems.
- We listened openly.
- Data Collection: Interviews were recorded (audio) and transcribed to capture detailed qualitative insights about their journey, interactions, pain points, and overall experience
- We used the 5WH framework, persona creation, and an empathy map to gain deeper insights into parents' needs, motivations, pain points, and emotions.

5W-H GRID (LINK)

The primary objective is to capture user experiences, motivations, feelings, and challenges to elicit deep insights. Each insight is broken down according to the following structure:

- **WHO**: Identifies the individuals involved in the situation and the key decision-makers.
- **WHAT**: Describes the user's experience, specific pain points, or unique observations during the insight. It also clarifies what is already known and what assumptions need validation.
- **WHEN**: Pinpoints the specific time the insight occurred during the user's journey.
- **WHERE**: Specifies the location where the insight occurred.
- **WHY**: Explores the importance of the insight, why it matters to the user.
- **HOW**: Details how the user is currently interacting with or coping with the situation, how the problem could be framed as an opportunity.
- **THINK**: Articulates the user's cognitive process—their thoughts, motivations, and any cognitive shifts that occurred during their experience.
- **FEEL**: Captures the user's actual emotions, providing a clear description of what they felt during the experience.

WHO	WHAT	WHEN	WHERE	WHY	HOW	THINK	FEEL
Shyam Narayan Jha (Shubham's Father - UG1) Decision Makers: IIIT-H Administration	Parents staying off-campus during their visit as there is no accommodation for them in campus	At the time of admission (2 day stay)	IIIT-H campus	Physical and emotional disconnect between parent and students. Parent want to feel connected, secure, and involved. Unresolved due to space constraints	walking back and forth from his hotel. opportunity to make parents feel truly welcome.	This top institute lack the on-campus guest houses as in IITs. If they stay inside the campus, they can meet their child two-three times a day. But if they are outside, it is not good to call the child there or to come again and again.	**Disconnected:** Missing out the feeling of being part of the IIIT-H community **Frustration:** inconvenience of the daily travel
	observable dirtiness and poor hygiene at the Tantra canteen	At the time of admission (2 day stay)	Tantra canteen	Forms negative perception about food quality in the campus.	Went to have meal there once, formed a negative opinion.	Isn't up to the standard. The place is noticeably dirty, especially compared to the mess	Disappointed Concerned
Aditya Puri (Bharti's Brother - UG1) Decision Makers: Warden	No proactive communication between parent and institute after the admission process. They wants to be notified **immediately** when a specific disciplinary or personal issue concerning his child arises.	Ongoing since they left the campus in July after Admissions.	Communication gap between parent's home and the warden's office/ administration	Parent needs to feel like a partner in their child's development and well-being, not just a passive observer **Conflict**: University believes communicating with the student is sufficient, but parents feel they are essential partners who are left out	He learned about a disciplinary action mail sent to his sister not from the warden, but from his sister herself, leaving him unable to understand the full context or offer support. Opportunity to build a structured communication protocol	Feels no official way of knowing how my sister is really doing academically or disciplinarily. The warden is perceived as "generally busy"	Anxious Worried Disconnected
Parents living far from Hyderabad, for whom a short trip requires significant planning.	Parent's presence requires extensive planning for an off-campus stay	During short holidays (e.g, Diwali break)	IIIT H campus	Celebrating festivals together is a fundamental family value and a key source of emotional well-being	The family is often forced to abandon the idea of a visit, which means the student and parents celebrates the festival alone.	For just a few days, the idea of searching for a hotel, booking it, and then managing all the travel to and from campus feels like complicated	Sad, Worried Conflicted: Strong desire to celebrate with their child and the practical burden of the required planning,

WHO	WHAT	WHEN	WHERE	WHY	HOW	THINK	FEEL
Bhaktilata Swain (Abhipsa's Mother- UG1) Parents seeking a loan Decision Makers: SBI and IIIT Administration	Lack of a clear contact person who could provide guidance before arriving on campus. (SBI Bank Manager was the single point of contact	During Admission (in July)	On-campus SBI branch	It adds mental stress. Since they cannot extend their stay, a small delay becomes a major crisis	They had to rely on a single, unresponsive point of contact. Being told to wait for hours and then being dismissed because the "printer isn't working."	To be told a broken printer is holding everything up is unprofessional. It is disrespectful to their time or the effort	Helpless Frustrated Anxious
Mothers visiting her children	Mother's inability to visit her daughter alone due to the logistical and perceived safety challenges of staying off-campus	During the regular academic year (whenever she wishes to visit her daughter)	IIIT-H campus (Guest House)	Makes the mother feel excluded from her daughter She wants to connect with her child, but the current situation is impractical and stressful	She copes by not visiting at all, while her husband visits alone	An on-campus guest house isn't a luxury, it's a necessity that would empower mother to visit her child without depending on her husband	Frustrated Helpless Left Out
N.S. Koranga (Deepti's Father- PG1)	Yuktahar Canteen has poor housekeeping, visible gas cylinders and general untidiness around the stairs. Vindhya Canteen was "overcrowded" with a "space constraint," He noted that the older buildings need to be "externally renovated," citing "many cracks" and unfinished areas where beams and columns were exposed	During his visits for both the interview and the admission process	Yuktahar Mess entrance Vindhya Canteen Old Academic buildings (Nilgiri)	Concerns about quality of food, safety Visible neglect contradicts institute's premium reputation and undermines his confidence that the environment is truly up to par	Entrance to Yuktahar mess, is unhygienic and smells foul At VC, they were continuously looking for a place to sit. While exploring, they observed cracks in the Old academic building	VC seems like temporary setup than a permanent, well-planned canteen. The old academic buildings need an external renovation	Concerned Disappointed

WHO	WHAT	WHEN	WHERE	WHY	HOW	THINK	FEEL
Shabbir Dhilawala (Mohammad's Father- UG1)	Faced difficulty in washing their own plate after a meal	During Admission (in July)	Kadamba Mess	While the system of washing plates is designed for students, its application to parents, who are guests, creates a moment of friction and unexpected labor during an already busy and stressful visit.	He follows the rule and washes his own plate, but the difficulty and inconvenience of the task created point of friction.	This is not a standard practice in public dining facilities. It's a bit of a hassle, and, I'm finding it a bit difficult	Surprised Inconvenienced Uncomfortable

WHO	WHAT	WHEN	WHERE	WHY	HOW	THINK	FEEL
Poornima's (Brother- PG1) Visiting parents who access mess Decision Maker: Mess/canteen management	He encountered "long line for payment" at the mess. Lack of dietary variety, particularly a shortage of North Indian cultural options in canteens	During Admission (in JULY)	Kadamba Mess Canteens	Inefficient processes waste their limited time on campus, while a lack of familiar food causes them to worry about their child's comfort and nutrition	Coped by waiting in the long queues, noting it was "manageable" but still a problem.	Mess didn't match their expectation Our time is getting wasted waiting in the lines I hope Poornima is adjusting and eating properly	Frustrated Concerned

Saritha (Meera's Mother- UG1) Non-English speaking parent Decision Maker: Orientation Programme Organisers	While she was present in the orientation session for the entire duration, the delivery was exclusively in English and she could not follow the crucial information being shared.	2-day orientation session during daughter's admission	Orientation Session in H-105	Orientation program's main goal is to build trust with all parents. A language barrier defeats this purpose for a segment of the audience, making them feel excluded.	She had to rely on her daughter. She didn't understand the full, nuanced information being presented directly from the source.	It would be better if her husband could come along with them so he can explain it to her and thus understand the IIIT environment better.	Excluded & Left Out Confused Dependent & Frustrated

Rajesh Deshpande (Ojas' Father- UG1)	To validate his son's choice of IIIT over an IIT, the parent made a special trip to campus the night before admissions. This self-initiated tour quickly became confusing due to a lack of guidance and effective signage.	A day before the official admission program	IIIT H campus	A parent's first impression is powerful. For a parent seeking validation, a confusing initial visit can create doubts about the institute.	The parent coped by wandering and asking guards for directions where possible, but ultimately had to cut his exploration short due to the confusion	There are no signs and maps, a top institute should be easy to navigate.	Eagerness (initially) Confused & Lost Disappointment

USER PERSONA :

Based on recurring themes and distinct experiences identified in the 5W-H analysis, we developed several parent personas to represent key user archetypes.

The Parent Missing the Connection

Name: Sunita Sharma
Age: 41
Location: Puri, Odisha

BACKGROUND

Sunita is a caring parent, deeply invested in her child's new life at IIIT Hyderabad.
She finds it difficult and impractical to travel alone for a short visit due to the logistical and perceived safety challenges of arranging an off-campus hotel stay.
She is acutely aware of short holidays, like Diwali, when her child cannot come home, and feels a strong need to bridge the distance but finds it impossible due to these barriers.

QUOTE:

"We want to visit, especially for the short holidays, but the biggest problem we face is simply where to stay. Staying outside makes everything feel impractical and disconnected."

MOTIVATION/ DESIRES

To feel connected, secure, and involved in her child's life. She wants to be able to visit the campus frequently and spontaneously.

To be physically present for emotional support, especially during short cultural holidays when her child cannot travel home.

To be empowered to visit her child without depending on her husband.

FRUSTATIONS

The feeling of being "excluded" from her child's world and missing out on being a part of the IIIT-H community because visits are so difficult for her to plan.

The logistical and perceived safety challenges of arranging an off-campus stay, which makes the entire trip feel impractical and stressful.

JOB TO BE DONE

To provide emotional support and maintain a strong family connection, ensuring her child doesn't feel isolated while away from home.

THEIR IDEAL EXPERIENCE

An on-campus guest house that empowers her to visit her child safely and conveniently, without having to depend on her husband. This would allow for easy, frequent interactions and the ability to feel like a welcome part of the IIIT-H community.

USER PERSONA

(LINK)

The Helpless Planner

Name: Rajeev Kumar
Age: 48
Location: Jaipur, Rajasthan

BACKGROUND

Rajeev is a meticulous planner and a proud father.
He has managed his finances carefully to support his daughter's education and is depending on the promised education loan to make her dream a reality.
He expected a clear and supportive process from a top institute but was instead met with a system that felt opaque and stressful.

QUOTE:

"We traveled 1600 km and followed every rule, only to be told a 'printer isn't working.' It's not a small delay; it's a crisis. It feels disrespectful, and you are left completely helpless."

MOTIVATION/ DESIRES

To secure his daughter's admission smoothly and efficiently, ensuring all financial formalities are completed without unnecessary stress.

To be treated with professionalism and respect, acknowledging the time, effort, and distance he has traveled for this crucial one-day process.

FRUSTATIONS

The immense mental stress caused by the lack of clear guidance, as the entire process relies on a single point of contact (the bank manager).

The financial burden of having to pay the hefty first-semester and seat acceptance fees (around ₹3 lakhs) upfront, and then waiting for a loan reimbursement.

Being dismissed with unprofessional excuses after waiting for hours, which turns a small delay into a major crisis for a family on a tight travel schedule.

JOB TO BE DONE

To navigate the administrative and financial hurdles of the admission process successfully, ensuring his daughter's transition into the university is secure and starts on a positive, stress-free note.

THEIR IDEAL EXPERIENCE

A streamlined, empathetic financial process with clear, proactive guidance and a dedicated support system for out-of-station parents.
An ideal system would not require upfront payment for approved loans and would have a well-resourced on-campus bank branch.

The Eager Explorer, Lost on Arrival

Name: Ramesh Singh
Age: 45
Location: Patna, Bihar

BACKGROUND

Ramesh is a highly engaged and proactive parent. Driven by the need to validate his son's choice of IIIT over a more traditional IIT, he made a special trip to the campus the night before the official admission program to conduct his own reconnaissance. His goal was to get a positive first impression, but this self-initiated tour quickly became a confusing experience due to a lack of effective guidance and signage.

QUOTE:

"A top institute should be easy to navigate. I came here looking for signs of excellence, but the first thing I found was confusion. The signs and maps in the campus were not clearly visible"

To have a smooth, self-driven exploration that confirms the institute is well-organised and welcoming even before the formal program begins.

To get a positive and reassuring first impression of the campus his son would be joining.

The lack of effective guidance and signage for a first-time visitor exploring the campus on their own.

JOB TO BE DONE

To independently assess the campus environment and confirm that it meets the high standards he expects, thereby gaining personal confidence in his son's major life decision.

THEIR IDEAL EXPERIENCE

A welcoming environment for early visitors with clear, modern signage or a self-guided tour map that empowers them to explore the campus confidently and form a positive first impression without needing to rely on chance encounters for directions.

We built 5 personas epresenting the shared experience of most visiting parents, derived from recurring needs, motivations, pain points, and emotional patterns identified through our 5W H analysis.

USER PERSONA

The Uninformed Parent

Name: Kavita Mittal
Age: 45
Location: Meerut, UP

BACKGROUND

Kavita is from a Hindi-speaking background.
During the admission process, she couldn't understand some of the crucial information being shared as the program was conducted in English.
This initial feeling of being an outsider has been amplified by a complete "information vacuum." She has had "zero communication" from the institute since her daughter's admission.

QUOTE:

First, I couldn't understand what they were saying at the orientation. Now, I hear nothing at all. When my child gets a disciplinary email and I have to hear it from them, how am I supposed to help if I don't even know the full context?"

MOTIVATION/ DESIRES

To feel like an informed partner in her child's development and well-being.

To receive clear, direct, and timely updates from the university, especially if a specific disciplinary or personal issue arises concerning her child.

FRUSTATIONS

Feeling excluded and confused during the induction program because of the language barrier, forcing her to rely on others for second-hand, incomplete information.

The "zero communication" from the institute post-admission, which makes her feel ignored and powerless to track her child's academic and disciplinary progress.

Hearing about a critical issue like a disciplinary action mail second-hand from her child, leaving her unable to understand the full context or offer effective support.

JOB TO BE DONE

To ensure her child is safe, supported, and thriving in their new environment.

THEIR IDEAL EXPERIENCE

An inclusive and communicative system where the university treats parents as essential partners. This would include providing key information from the induction in multiple languages and establishing a proactive, reliable channel for regular updates and urgent communication.

The Standards-Driven Observer

Name: Sanjeev Gupta
Age: 56
Location: Delhi

BACKGROUND

Mr. Gupta is a discerning parent with a keen eye for detail. Having visited other premier institutes like IITs, he arrived at IIIT Hyderabad with high expectations, believing its "renowned" reputation would be reflected in all aspects of the campus.
While impressed by the academics, he was taken aback by the significant disconnect between the institute's prestige and the on-ground reality of its physical infrastructure, hygiene, and amenities

QUOTE:

"The gut feeling about the college is good because of its reputation. But for a premier institute, the physical environment must also be up to the mark. I noticed many things—from cracks in the walls i the old academic building to unclean mess areas—that simply don't match that standard."

MOTIVATION/ DESIRES

To see the institute's academic excellence reflected in a high-quality, well-maintained, and safe physical environment for his child.

To have access to clean, hygienic, and diverse food options on campus.

He expects all dining facilities to meet a consistently high standard of cleanliness and safety.

FRUSTATIONS

Widespread Infrastructure Neglect: He is frustrated by the visible disrepair of older academic buildings, which he noted have "many cracks" and need to be "externally renovated".

Poorly Managed Dining Facilities: He is concerned by inconsistent standards, citing "observable dirtiness and poor hygiene" (Tantra) ,safety hazards like "visible gas cylinders" (Yuktahar), and "overcrowded" canteens that feel like a "temporary setup" (Vindhya).

Perceived lack of dietary variety, particularly a shortage of North Indian cultural options

JOB TO BE DONE

To validate that the institute provides a holistic, high-quality environment that justifies its reputation and fees, ensuring his child's daily life is safe, comfortable, and well-catered for.

THEIR IDEAL EXPERIENCE

An impeccably maintained campus where the physical infrastructure, hygiene standards, and dining facilities all match the university's world-academic reputation,.

EMPATHY MAP

Name: Sunita Sharma

THINKING & FEELING

- "I miss being around my child. I wish I could visit more often."
- Feels anxious, excluded, and dependent on her husband for travel.
- Frustrated by perceived safety concerns and logistics that make short visits feel impossible.

SEEING

- In other institutes, parents freely visiting their children.
- Students celebrating festivals without families.
- Limited on-campus stay options or female-friendly guest facilities.

HEARING

- Other mothers saying it's unsafe or impractical to visit alone.
- Her child reassuring her: "Don't worry, I'll be fine here."
- Family members saying travel isn't necessary.

SAYING & DOING

- "I want to visit but it's too hard to manage alone."
- Checks hotel options, but gives up due to logistics or safety.
- Sends food or gifts instead of visiting.
- Expresses guilt for missing festivals or short holidays.

PAINS

- Limited on-campus accommodation.
- Emotional distance and feeling of disconnection.
- Dependence on husband for travel and arrangements.

GAINS

- On-campus guest house with easy access.
- Freedom to visit independently anytime.
- Stronger emotional connection and belonging in the IIIT-H community.

EMPATHY MAP

(LINK)

EMPATHY MAP

Name: Rajeev Kumar

THINKING & FEELING

- "I've planned everything carefully—why is this process so chaotic?"
- Frustrated that the entire admission process depends on a single bank manager who isn't responding.
- Worried about missing deadlines and losing his daughter's seat despite doing everything right.

SEEING

- Confused staff giving vague answers like "Sir, please wait."
- Technical issues delaying important formalities.

HEARING

- "Please wait, the system isn't working."
- "Come back tomorrow."
- Other parents sharing similar frustrations about the loan process.

SAYING & DOING

- "We traveled all this way, and now we're waiting because of a broken printer?"
- Double-checks all documents, calls the bank repeatedly.
- Notes inefficiencies and complains politely but firmly.

PAINS

- Unclear loan procedures and lack of proactive support.
- Financial strain due to upfront payment before loan approval.
- Feeling helpless despite being organized and responsible.

GAINS

- Dedicated, transparent parent-help desk or financial support team.
- No upfront payment for approved loans.
- Respectful, efficient handling that acknowledges parents' time and effort.

EMPATHY MAP

Name: Kavita Mittal

THINKING & FEELING

- "I want to understand everything about my daughter's life here."
- Feels excluded and powerless because of the language barrier.
- Worries that she's missing out on important information.

SEEING

- Orientation sessions being conducted in English.
- Parents from urban, English-speaking backgrounds engaging confidently.
- No clear follow-up communication from the institute.

HEARING

- "You'll understand it later; everything's fine."
- Her child mentioning things she should've been informed about by the university.

SAYING & DOING

- "Why doesn't the university send updates in Hindi?"
- Relies on her daughter to translate official messages.
- Asks other parents for updates or explanations.

PAINS

- Language barrier during orientation and communication.
- No direct or official parent updates post-admission.
- Feels powerless to intervene or support when issues arise.

GAINS

- Parent-friendly communication system.
- Timely updates from the institute.
- Feeling included, respected, and informed about her child's journey.

EMPATHY MAP

Name: Ramesh Singh

THINKING & FEELING

- "I wanted to explore and feel confident about my son's choice."
- Feels confused and disappointed when campus navigation is unclear.
- Realization that the campus relies on people for directions, not proper signage.

SEEING

- Lack of visible signage or campus maps.
- Empty or unmarked pathways during his visit.

HEARING

- "Yes, I'll guide you — it's a little confusing to find on your own."
- Other visitors saying, "You always have to ask someone here; there are no clear signs."

SAYING & DOING

- "A top institute should be easier to navigate."
- Tries exploring on his own, asking guards for help.

PAINS

- Poor campus navigation and signage.
- Negative first impression before admissions.
- Frustration and wasted time while exploring.

GAINS

- Clear, multilingual campus maps and signage.
- Self-guided tour app for visitors.
- Confident, welcoming first experience that builds trust.

EMPATHY MAP

Name: Sanjeev Gupta

THINKING & FEELING

- "An institute of this caliber should reflect excellence everywhere."
- Disappointed by physical infrastructure not matching academic standards.
- Concerned about hygiene and safety in dining areas.

SEEING

- Cracked, unrenovated old academic buildings.
- Dirty, overcrowded canteens (Vindhya, Tantra).
- Unsafe elements like open gas cylinders or poor ventilation.

HEARING

- "This mess is always crowded."
- "Food hygiene could be better."
- "Other IITs have better upkeep."

SAYING & DOING

- "For a premier institute, this doesn't look right."
- Takes mental notes, discusses observations with other parents.
- Compares IIIT-H to IITs and finds a gap in facilities.

PAINS

- Unclean, unsafe, and inconsistent dining conditions.
- Lack of visible maintenance or renovation.
- Disappointment undermining faith in the institute's brand.

GAINS

- Clean, safe, and well-maintained campus environment.
- Hygienic and diverse food options (including North Indian).
- Pride and reassurance that his child is in a world-class environment.

USER JOURNEY MAP

(LINK)

PERSONA	SCENARIO	GOALS & EXPECTATIONS
Sunita Sharma The Parent Missing the Connection	Attempting to visit her child on campus for a short holiday	To visit her child frequently and spontaneously, and provide emotional support without depending on her husband

STAGES OF JOURNEY	Considering a Visit	Researching Logistics	Deciding Against Visit	Alternative Connection
ACTIVITIES	Reminisces about missing her child and upcoming short holidays.	Checks hotel and accommodation options.	Hears other mothers saying it's unsafe or impractical to visit alone. Gives up on visiting due to logistics or safety.	Sends food or gifts instead of visiting. Expresses guilt for missing festivals.
THINKING	"I miss being around my child. I wish I could visit more often." "She can't come home for this short holiday, so I should go."	"Where would I stay? Are these hotels safe and convenient? How will I manage alone?"	"Other mothers also find it difficult. Maybe it's just too impractical and stressful to manage alone right now."	"At least I can send something. I feel bad missing Diwali, but hopefully, she understands." "I hope she's really okay."
Feeling & Needs	**Feeling**: Longing, Desire for Connection. **Need**: To bridge emotional distance.	**Feeling**: Anxious, Uncertain. **Need**: Safety, Convenience, Independence.	**Feeling**: Frustrated, Discouraged, Dependent. **Need**: Empowerment, Practical Solution.	**Feeling**: Guilty, Resigned, Worried. **Need**: Reassurance, Alternative ways to show care.
Experience	🤔✉️ **Wishing**: Feeling the distance and wanting to visit.	😟🗺️ **Stressed**: Facing the daunting task of finding a safe place to stay alone.	😩🚫 **Defeated**: Overwhelmed by the difficulties, the visit feels impossible.	😔🍽️ **Making do**: Trying to connect through gifts, but feeling sad about missing out.
PAIN POINTS	Emotional distance and disconnection.	Limited on-campus stay options; logistical and perceived safety challenges of off-campus stay.	Dependence on husband for travel/arrangements. Trip feels impractical and stressful.	Feeling excluded because visits are hard to plan. Missing important family events.
OPPORTUNITIES	Facilitate stronger emotional connection.	Provide an easily accessible, safe on-campus guest house.	Empower independent visits for mothers.	Enable physical presence for emotional support.
AREA OF RESPONSIBITY	Student Support/Welfare & Parent Relations.	Campus Administration & Facilities (Guest House Management). Campus Security (Safe transport/stay options).	Parent/Alumni Relations (Visitation policies).	Institutional Leadership & Policy.

PERSONA	SCENARIO	GOALS & EXPECTATIONS
Rajeev Kumar The Helpless Planner	Completing the administrative and financial hurdles during the one-day admission process, relying on an education loan	Secure his daughter's admission smoothly and efficiently, ensuring financial formalities are completed without stress

STAGES OF JOURNEY	Pre-Admission Preparation	On-Campus Formalities	Dealing with Delays/Issues	Finalizing Admission
ACTIVITIES	Travels 1600 km, checks docs. Relies on loan. Tries contacting unresponsive bank manager (single POC).	Waits for loan process at bank branch. Interacts with staff/manager. Observes confused staff.	Hears excuses ("printer isn't working"). Complains politely. Hears other parents' frustrations.	Pays ~₹3 lakh fee upfront, hoping for reimbursement. (Uses personal connection to expedite) .
THINKING	"Planned carefully; should be smooth." "Why no clear answer from the bank before traveling?". "Hope we don't need to pay upfront."	"Why so slow? Process relies on one busy manager.". "Staff seems unsure."	"1600 km travel, now a broken printer? Unprofessional!". "Can't extend stay; this delay is a crisis."	"Had to pay anyway. What about families without cash?". "Chaotic process, not expected from a top institute."
Feeling & Needs	**Feeling**: Organized, Hopeful, Anxious (finances). **Need**: Clarity, Reliable Communication.	**Feeling**: Frustrated, Impatient. **Need**: Efficiency, Professionalism.	**Feeling**: Helpless, Disrespected, Stressed. **Need**: Resolution, Respect for time.	**Feeling**: Resigned, Concerned for others. **Need**: Fairness, Empathy.
Experience	🤔📋 **Anxious Planning**: Prepared but worried about the unclear loan process.	😟⏳ **Frustrating Wait**: Stuck due to reliance on a single, busy contact.	😠🏙️ **Crisis Point**: Unprofessional delays jeopardized his tight schedule.	😔💸 **Forced Payment**: Paid upfront despite loan, questioning fairness.
PAIN POINTS	Unclear loan procedures; no proactive support. Single, unresponsive POC. Financial strain from potential upfront payment.	Over-reliance on one bank manager. Confused staff, vague answers.	Technical issues (broken printer) cause major delays. Disrespectful handling of parents on tight schedules.	Feeling helpless despite organization. High-stress, crisis-like process.
OPPORTUNITIES	Provide clear guidance; Offer more contacts/helpdesk. Eliminate upfront payment for approved loans.	Ensure adequate bank staffing/resources during peak times.	Have backup procedures for tech failures. Train staff for professional, empathetic handling.	Streamline financial process; make it respectful & efficient.
AREA OF RESPONSIBITY	Financial Aid Office & Partner Bank Mgmt. Admissions & Parent Relations.	Partner Bank Mgmt & Staffing.	Admissions & Admin Tech/Support. Process Design & Staff Training.	Financial Aid Office & Institutional Policy.

We mapped the typical journey for each persona during their campus visit, focusing on Touchpoints, activities performed, thoughts and feelings experienced, and identifying specific pain points and opportunities at each step.

USER JOURNEY MAP

	PERSONA	SCENARIO	GOALS & EXPECTATIONS
	Kavita Mittal The Parent Missing the Connection	Attending the orientation program and subsequently seeking updates on her child's progress	To feel like an informed partner in her child's development and receive clear, direct, and timely updates from the university

STAGES OF JOURNEY	Attending Orientation	Seeking Post-Admission Info	Reacting to Critical Information	Ideal State
ACTIVITIES	Attends session but notes it's only in English. Watches others engage confidently. Relies on others for summaries later.	Asks daughter to translate messages. Asks other parents for updates. Notes lack of proactive institute communication.	Hears about issues (disciplinary email) second-hand from child. Unable to get full context from university.	Receives timely, understandable updates from university. Feels empowered to ask questions and discuss concerns.
THINKING	"Want to understand, but can't follow English.". "Why no key points in Hindi?". "Other parents seem comfortable."	"Why no Hindi updates?". "How is my child really doing?". "Heard nothing since admission."	"Disciplinary email? What happened? Need full story to help.". "How can I help without context?"	"Finally, included and respected.". "Now I can properly partner with the university."
Feeling & Needs	**Feeling**: Excluded, Confused, Powerless. **Need**: Inclusion, Understanding, Direct Info.	**Feeling**: Anxious, Ignored, Dependent. **Need**: Proactive Communication, Transparency.	**Feeling**: Worried, Frustrated, Powerless. **Need**: Full Context, Ability to Intervene/Support.	**Feeling**: Included, Respected, Informed, Confident. **Need**: Partnership, Trust.
Experience	😟🗣️ **Excluded**: Present but not understanding, feeling left out.	❓📞 **Disconnected**: Relies only on child for info, anxious about the unknown.	🤯✉️ **Powerless**: Learns of critical issues indirectly, can't get full story or help.	🤝✅ **Partnering**: Receives clear updates, feels like a valued community member.
PAIN POINTS	Language barrier during orientation. Forced reliance on second-hand info.	No direct parent updates post-admission ("zero communication"). No clear follow-up.	Hears critical issues second-hand from child. Unable to get full context. Powerless to intervene/support.	(Pain Points Eliminated).
OPPORTUNITIES	Provide key info/summaries in multiple languages.	Implement parent-friendly communication system (portal, newsletters). Provide timely updates.	Establish proactive, reliable channel for urgent communication.	Build strong partnership and trust with families.
AREA OF RESPONSIBILITY	Institutional Communications & Event Mgmt.	IT/Digital Services & Parent Relations.	Student Support/Welfare & Counseling (Warden, Deans).	Institutional Leadership & Policy.

	PERSONA	SCENARIO	GOALS & EXPECTATIONS
	Sanjeev Gupta The Standards-Driven Observer	Visiting the campus with high expectations and comparing its facilities to premier institutions like IITs	To validate that the institute's academic excellence is reflected in a high-quality and safe physical environment

STAGES OF JOURNEY	Arrival & Initial Impression	Observing Infrastructure	Evaluating Dining Facilities	Final Assessment
ACTIVITIES	Arrives with high expectations based on reputation. Compares IIIT-H to IITs visited	Takes mental notes observing older academic buildings. Discusses observations with others.	Observes hygiene/conditions of canteens/messes (Tantra, Yuktahar, Vindhya, Palash). Notes overcrowding @Temp. setups. Notes lack of desired food variety (North Indian).	Forms overall opinion contrasting strong academics with subpar physical environment.
THINKING	"Gut feeling is good due to reputation.". "Does campus match IIT standards?"	"Older buildings look worn; cracks visible.". "Needs renovation.". "Premier institute needs better upkeep."	"This place (Tantra/Yuktahar entrance) is dirty/unsafe.". "This one (Vindhya) feels overcrowded/temporary.". "Food hygiene/options could be better."	"Academics strong, but campus doesn't reflect same excellence.". "Clear gap between brand and reality."
Feeling & Needs	**Feeling**: Hopeful, Expectant. **Need**: Validation of reputation.	**Feeling**: Disappointed, Concerned. **Need**: Visible high standards, Quality maintenance.	**Feeling**: Concerned (Hygiene/Safety), Frustrated (Crowding/Variety). **Need**: Cleanliness, Safety, Efficiency, Diversity.	**Feeling**: Contradicted, Slightly Disappointed. **Need**: Holistic excellence.
Experience	🤔🔍 **Expectant**: Arriving with high standards, ready to compare.	😡📉 **Observing Flaws**: Noticing visible disrepair on buildings.	🤢🍽️ **Dining Disappointment**: Concerned by hygiene, crowding, lack of options.	😐📉 **Gap Identified**: Sees disconnect between reputation and physical standards.
PAIN POINTS	High expectations create critical lens. Disconnect between prestige & reality	Visible disrepair ("cracks") needs "external renovation". Infrastructure Neglect.	Unclean, unsafe dining (Tantra dirt, Yuktahar gas cylinders). Overcrowded, temporary canteens (Vindhya). Lack of desired dietary variety.	Amenities don't match premier standard. Disappointment undermines brand faith.
OPPORTUNITIES	Leverage reputation by ensuring facilities match.	Renovate older buildings. Proactive maintenance plan.	Standardize hygiene. Address safety hazards. Improve canteen space. Diversify menu.	Align physical environment with academics. Provide holistic, high-quality experience.
AREA OF RESPONSIBILITY	Institutional Branding & Comms.	Campus Facilities & Maintenance Dept.	Mess/Catering Services Mgmt. Campus Facilities.	Strategic Planning & Capital Projects. Institutional Leadership.

Persona 5: Ramesh Singh (The Eager Explorer, Lost on Arrival)

1. **Confidence & Validation (for Parents, Students, Future Prospects)**

"First-time parents and visitors who wish to explore the campus independently and confidently struggle to do so because the lack of clear, modern wayfinding and signage causes confusion and frustration. They would benefit from an intuitive, well-designed wayfinding system that supports effortless navigation, validates their sense of orientation, and fulfills their motivation for confident, independent exploration of the institute."

2. **Order & Professionalism (for Administration)**

"The absence of a unified, self-service campus guidance system compromises Order and Professionalism, leading to wasted staff time and a negative, disorganized first impression ."

USERS	NEEDS	INSIGHTS
Parent: Proactive visitors motivated to confirm the choice.	Confidence & Validation through intuitive, reliable wayfinding and self-guided navigation systems.	The lack of clear signage prevents confident, independent exploration
Administration	Order & Professionalism via a unified, self-service campus guidance infrastructure for all visitors.	The absence of a unified system compromises Order and Professionalism, leading to wasted staff time and a negative, disorganized first impression that violates the Motivation for organizational excellence.

POV (POINT OF VIEWS)

- Parents — who want clarity, connection, and confidence during their visit
- Students — who often become the bridge between their parents and campus information
- Administration — who aim to maintain smooth operations, security, and a positive institutional image

By considering these three viewpoints, we ensured that our problem framing was balanced, user-centred, and grounded in real motivations, constraints, and system realities.

(LINK)

PERSONA 1: Sunita Sharma (The Parent Missing the Connection)

1. **Connectedness & Security (for Parents, Students)**

" A visiting mother who wishes to stay connected with her child on campus struggles to feel secure and emotionally close because there is no safe, independent, and easily accessible accommodation available for her stay. She would benefit from thoughtfully designed on-campus living options that provide comfort, privacy, and convenience, helping her feel secure and emotionally connected while maintaining the family bond."

2. T**rust & Efficiency (for Adminstration/ IIIT H Community)**

" Administrators and the campus community who strive to uphold the institute's values of care and community support struggle to maintain efficiency and trust because the limited on-campus accommodation create logistical gaps and inconsistency in support. They would benefit from a cohesive, well-structured visitor management process integrated with accessible accommodation options, helping them strengthen operational efficiency, trust, and alignment with the institute's core value of community support."

USERS	NEEDS	INSIGHTS
Parent: A caring, out-station mother who finds it difficult and impractical to travel alone	To feel Connected and Secure by having safe, independent, and easily available on-campus guest accommodation	The absence of official, accessible accommodation prevents her to provide support and maintain a strong bond, actively causing emotional distance and personal insecurity
Student: The child who needs emotional support and wants to feel a sense of belonging.	To have easy, reliable access to family presence on campus during short breaks	When parents cannot visit, the student feels **isolated** and **disconnected**, undermining the family's motivation to provide a positive, supported experience
Administration/ IIIT H Community	To implement **structured, managed visitor support** that aligns operations with institutional values	The existing deficit compromises operational Efficiency and undermines community Trust by failing to align physical support with the institutional value of parental engagement

POV's

Persona 2: Rajeev Kumar (The Helpless Planner)

1. **Respect & Confidence (for Parents, Students)**

" Parents and students who seek a smooth and professional admission experience struggle with stress and uncertainty because the current financial clearance process is opaque and demands large upfront payments. They would benefit from a transparent, flexible, and well-supported financial clearance system that reduces stress, enables smoother onboarding, and helps them begin their academic journey with confidence and peace of mind."

2. Order & Accountability (for Financial Partner/ Administration)

" Administrators and finance staff are motivated to maintain the institution's reputation for professionalism, but a lack of structured, redundant financial workflows compromises Order and Accountability, leading to high-stakes chaos "

USERS	NEEDS	INSIGHTS
Parent & Student: Meticulous planner, expecting professional service	A stress-free financial start that is transparent, eliminates large upfront fees, and treats their effort and time with Respect.	The opaque, single-point-of-failure process betrays the motivation for a smooth start, causing high financial stress and diminishing Confidence in the institution's professionalism.
Administration/ Financial Partner: Staff responsible for compliance and operational flow	Order & Accountability through structured, redundant financial workflows and clear protocols.	The lack of structured workflows compromises Order and Accountability, leading to operational chaos that directly damages the institute's reputation during critical admission periods.

Persona 3: Kavita Mittal (The Uninformed Parent)

1. **Inclusion & Empowerment (for Parents)**

“Parents who seek to stay informed and actively engaged in the institute’s activities struggle to build an effective partnership because there is no multilingual communication policy or official communication platform. They would benefit from a clear, multilingual, and centralized communication system that keeps them consistently informed, empowered, and better able to provide meaningful support within the academic ecosystem.”

2. Compliance & Trust (for Institute)

“Wardens and communication staff who aim to maintain institutional compliance and transparent engagement struggle to uphold trust because the current communication structure marginalizes non-English-speaking parents, leading to frequent miscommunication and disengagement. They would benefit from an inclusive, multilingual communication framework that ensures clarity, compliance, and equal access to information, helping rebuild parental trust and strengthening the institute’s accountability. ”

USERS	NEEDS	INSIGHTS
Parent: Non-English speaking parent motivated to be an informed partner	Inclusion & Empowerment through consistent, multilingual communication of academic and disciplinary context.	The English-only policy blocks the parent from informed partnership, preventing Empowerment and the ability to provide effective support when issues arise.
Wardens, Communication Staff	Compliance & Trust via a reliable, centralized communication platform that is traceable and consistent.	The unstandardized structure erodes parental Trust and compromises institutional Compliance by forcing students to bear the high-risk burden of translating critical official information.

POV’s

Persona 4: Sanjeev Gupta (The Standards-Driven Observer)

1. **Reassurance (for Parents)**

“Parents and visitors who expect the campus to embody the institute’s commitment to quality and care struggle to feel reassured because visible infrastructure decline and poor hygiene contradict their expectations of excellence. They would benefit from a well-maintained, hygienic, and visually consistent campus environment that reinforces pride, trust, and confidence in the institute’s ability to provide holistic student well-being.”

2. Integrity & Excellence (for Institute)

“Administrators and campus planners who strive to uphold the institute’s integrity and reputation for excellence struggle to do so because the substandard physical environment creates a reputational drag and visually disconnects the campus from its academic and physical standards of excellence. They would benefit from a cohesive infrastructure renewal strategy that visibly aligns the campus environment with the institute’s values of quality, integrity, and holistic excellence.”

USERS	NEEDS	INSIGHTS
Parent : require visual confirmation of quality.)	Reassurance through visibly well-maintained facilities, high hygiene standards, and operational excellence.	The Motivation to validate quality is undermined by poor hygiene and visible decline, causing a significant loss of confidence and introducing doubt about holistic student well-being and safety.
Administration	Integrity & Excellence via robust, consistent maintenance protocols and visible quality standards across all infrastructure.	The substandard physical environment compromises institutional Integrity and visual Excellence, creating a Reputational Drag that fails to align the campus's physical reality with its academic prestige.

HMW STATEMENTS

1. HMW REDESIGN A COMMUNICATION EXPERIENCE FOR PARENTS VISITING IIIT H THAT KEEPS THEM CONNECTED TO ONGOING CAMPUS HAPPENINGS, SO THAT IT LEADS TO HIGHER PARENT-INSTITUTE ENGAGEMENT AND HELP THEM FEEL MORE CONNECTED TO IIIT-H COMMUNITY.

2. HOW MIGHT WE ESTABLISH A CONSISTENT, OFFICIAL, AND MULTILINGUAL COMMUNICATION CHANNEL THAT ENABLES PARENTS TO EASILY ACCESS, UNDERSTAND, AND ENGAGE WITH INSTITUTE UPDATES IN THEIR PREFERRED LANGUAGE, SO THAT THEY FEEL INCLUDED,EMPOWERED, AND DEVELOP TRUST THROUGH AN INFORMED PARTNERSHIP WITH THE INSTITUTE?

3. HOW MIGHT WE ESTABLISH A CONSISTENT, OFFICIAL, AND MULTILINGUAL COMMUNICATION CHANNEL THAT ENABLES PARENTS TO EASILY ACCESS, UNDERSTAND, AND ENGAGE WITH INSTITUTE UPDATES IN THEIR PREFERRED LANGUAGE, SO THAT THEY FEEL INCLUDED, EMPOWERED, AND DEVELOP TRUST THROUGH AN INFORMED PARTNERSHIP WITH THE INSTITUTE?

4. HOW MIGHT WE REIMAGINE THE LOAN PROCESS DURING INDUCTION TO FEEL CALM, GUIDED, AND EFFICIENT — ENSURING PARENTS FEEL SUPPORTED AND RESPECTED, AND THE INSTITUTE MAINTAINS AN ORGANIZED AND PROFESSIONAL ENVIRONMENT?

RICE PRIORITISATION

HMW Statement	Reach	Impact	Confidance	Effort
1	High	Very High	High	Low
2	Medium	Medium	High	High
3	Very High	Very High	Very High	Medium
4	Medium	High	HIgh	Medium

FINAL ACTIONABLE PROBLEM STATEMENT

HMW DESIGN A COMMUNICATION EXPERIENCE FOR PARENTS VISITING IIIT H THAT KEEPS THEM CONNECTED TO ONGOING CAMPUS HAPPENINGS, SO THAT IT LEADS TO HIGHER PARENT-INSTITUTE ENGAGEMENT AND HELP THEM FEEL MORE CONNECTED TO IIIT-H COMMUNITY.

IDEATION

ROUND ROBIN BRAINSTORMING

We set a 5-minute timer for each round:
3 minute to write an idea, 2 minutes to discuss.
Then we passed our ideas to the next person so they could build on it or create a new one.
We repeated this for 13 rounds and ended up with 50+ ideas using methods like

- What If
- Opposite Thinking
- SCAMPER

Parents ask questions or contribute ideas on public boards, making the campus feel inclusive
Instead of formal signboards outside CAR stores, small symbols, or parents reveal updates
Parents explore,
AR-based tour which will detect hesitation or wandering and proactively offer help.
What if updates works at All Symbolic system using icons, gradients, flickering making it universal.
Short 10-15 min casual sessions where faculties & parents chatted and faculties shared about the events, initiatives and what's going at IIITH
A tunnel summarising the week through audio, projections & student clips
Substitute physical signboards with floating AR among daily visible thru' phone
Each news item is accompanied by a video of a student or faculty sharing the
A parent role space where updates & info appear on coasters, walls, tables, mugs, etc
What if ZOST-H had an 'Update maze', A playful maze where each corner reveals a diff angery activity.
Parents drive a card that reveal a surprise story happening at
A 10-15 min short casual talk between faculty and parents where faculty share updates about
A wall where alumni voice normally how institute helped them, giving, making proud hopeful & serve
Today@NIT-H waits for you!
Students feel not left with a year
Parents submit their interpretations of what they saw & submit the feedback.
If it rains, parents will be updated that events have been shifted indoors
When parents enter a campus building, a simplified version of ongoing activities is projected near entrance
Parents hear voice chips of students sharing their experiences & achievements (story capsule)
A small roaming robot in the campus plaza that cheerfully answers guides and happenings.
Parents who have already visited campus will record small voice
What if we design Campus orientation like walking thro' chapters of 'books' like Chap-1: innovation Chap-2: student culture,
Signboards that glow or pulse slightly something important is about
Summarise long academic or admin notifications automatically become parent-friendly during orientation.
What if parent open campus as from home → unexplored places
Small holographic Pop-ups appears at key spots displaying 'something happening here'!
Parents can Pin their interest on APPOS whatever chatbot, then they will receive updates auto. any from their interested labs, innovation or seminars.
AR lens that scans building like KRB that give photon of labs & activities happening
Divide into 3 main research, Robotic, sections so campus is guiding them when to go (LED lights)
Install interactive benches on campus that guide them, maybe color that if they never needed
Trees around campus have tiny audio carving giving short snippets when parents walk
Design a whatsapp Chatbot which will give all the updates, when parents needed them. they need not to
Build a future or "forecast lens" showing predicted events, expected research outcomes, or upcoming community activities.
A weekly AI digest summarising complex research, achievements, and activities in simple, friendly lang. And hand over this digest to parents when they visit IIIT.
Parents hear updates about labs, clubs, student achievements directly from students instead of reading them (in story form)
A virtual schedule assistant that reorganizes the parent's day based on new events, last minute changes or canceled
Build a tourist - cafe space where updates appears on coasters, table and walls - turning the visit into a
During events we make a light trail that automatically guides them
Parents ask questions or contribute ideas on public boards, making the campus feel inclusive
Substitute physical signboards with floating AR among daily visible thru' phone
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(LINK)

IDEA CLUSTERING

WE ENDED UP WITH 50+ IDEAS, AND IT WAS GETTING IMPOSSIBLE TO COMPARE OR PRIORITIZE THEM INDIVIDUALLY. SO, WE GROUPED THEM TO SEE PATTERNS, UNDERSTAND WHICH IDEAS WERE SOLVING SIMILAR PROBLEMS, AND MAKE OUR NEXT STEPS (PRIORITIZING + SELECTING) MUCH EASIER.

1

HUMAN INCLUSIVE

Ideas that make parents feel supported through people-driven touchpoints — guards, staff, help desks, multilingual support.

2

EXPERI-MENTAL

Ideas that were more future-facing, pushing boundaries .

3

NAVIGATION

Ideas that help parents move around campus easily and confidently.

4

REAL TIME INFORMATION

Ideas that give parents real-time, updated information like events, mess menu, announcements.

(LINK)

GROUP-1 INCLUSIVE, HUMAN-ORIENTED DESIGN

Once a month some clubs or labs open exclusively for parents

A 10-15 min short casual talk between faculty and parents where faculty share updates about college events & initiatives & achievements with parents

Each college club perform something to welcome parents (dance, drama, photography)

Parents ask questions or contribute messages on public boards, making the campus feel inclusive

Parents hear voice clips of students sharing their experience & achievements (story capsule)

Students greet parents with a warm 'welcome to IIITH' upon parents campus entry

'wall' where alumni ca narrates how titute helped them ney, making parents ful & secure.

each news item is accompanied by a video of a student or faculty sharing the update in video format

Short 10-15 min casual sessions where faculties & parents chatted and faculties shared about the events, initiating

A parent cafe space where updates & info appear on coasters, walls, tables, mugs etc.

Parents who have already visited campus will record small voice notes about what impressed them about IIITH

A parents 'welcome buddy' system making new parents feel informed & supported when they enter campus

Build a Parent-Cafe space where updates appears on coasters, table and walls - turning the visit into a team memorable experience.

Parents hear updates about labs, clubs, student achievements directly from students instead of reading them

GROUP-2 CREATIVE, EXPERIMENTAL

What if updates had NO words at All where a symbolic system using icons, gradients, patterns making it universal.

A tunnel summarising the week through audio, projections, student clips

What if there are no notifications — updates are given through sounds, pattern on walls

Parents submit their interpretations of what they saw; & submit the feedback.

What if parent explore campus as a treasure hunt → unexpected places.

What if campus sky Projects updates? Domes/side light beams show simple symbols in the sky to signal important events.

like Harry potter, Creatures are associated (mascot) with every building, they give updates & information

Parents drive a card that reveal a surprise story happening at IIIT-H

Build a future or "forecast lens" showing predicted events, expected research outcomes, or upcoming community activities.

A small roaming robot in the campus plaza that cheerfully announces events and happenings.

Color coded paths on ground (on asphalt) to guide parents around campus.

Small holographic Pop-ups appear at key spots displaying 'something cool happening here'!

Substitute physical signboards with floating AR arrows only visible thro' phone cameras.

Build a Digital pet for parents which will grows as parents interact with more campus updates

What if ZEST-H had an 'Update maze', ie A playful maze where each corners reveals a diff'n organ activity.

GROUP-3 NAVIGATION, SMOOTH EXPERIENCE

Install interactive benches on campus that guide them, maybe color

What if they never needed a map

Trees around campus have tiny audio cameos giving short snippets when parents walk

AR lens that scans building like KRB that give photos of labs, activities happening

Create a storybook where a 'Sequential "story walk"' each stop reveals a new piece of campus life.

Divide into 3 trails research, Robotics, street recreational so campus is guiding them when to go (LED lights)

Signboards that glow brighter or pulse slightly when something important is happening in that direction

During events we make a light trail that automatically guides them.

A Smart map that Zooms highlights only relevant spots and parent's current location (real time)

When parents enter a campus building, a simplified version of organ activities is projected near entrance

What if we design campus orientation like 'talking thro' chapters of book'

ie Chap-1: innovation

Chap-2: student culture

Instead of formal signboards subtle QR stones, wall symbols, or parrens reveal updates when Parents explore.

A digital 360° view app that will use help to navigate and showcase memories of places that child can act

Today@IIIT-H Walls for parent

GROUP-4 REAL TIME INFORMATION

Notify the updates like Morning events, Afternoon events, announcement & in the evening achievements & recaps.

If it rains, Parents will be updated that events have been shifted indoors

Combine ZEST-H CCTV heatmaps + event schedules to show parents the most active "hotspots" in real time.

~~A 'fitness tracker~~ A 'campus tracker' showing showing current events & updates going around campus.

AI-powered soil which will detect hesitation or wandering and proactively offer help.

Substitute printed maps with dynamic AR footprints on the ground that parents can follow.

What if Parents weren't visible - only audible? like short ambient tones signal important stuff'n diff'n tones for research, culture, sports.

Design a whatsapp chatbot which will give all the updates, when parents needed them. They need not to install any

Parents can pin their interest on APPor whatsapp chatbot, then they will receive updates auto. only from their intended labs, innovator or seminars.

Combine NFC + digital screens so that Parents tap their phone on NFC points to trigger screens showing live events organized nearby.

A virtual schedule assistant that reorganizes the parent's day based on new events, last minute changes or crowded areas

A weekly AI digest summarizing complex research, achievements, and activities in simple, friendly langu. And handover this digest to Parents when they visit ZEST.

Design a channel where geo-location trigger system will activate & give updates to Parents when they need.

Summarise long academic or admin notifications automatically become parent-friendly during orientation.

What if updates reach parents → a badge or device that vibrates if something interesting is happening

Install digital screens which have posters to update event, timing, highlights

To choose which idea group to take forward, we used the RICE method.

This helped us compare all four groups based on

- how many parents it would help
- how much impact it would create
- how confident we were about the need, and
- how feasible it was to implement

WHY “REAL-TIME INFORMATION” BECAME OUR TOP CHOICE

1

HIGH REACH

This supports every parent visiting the campus.

2

HIGH IMPACT

It directly improves clarity, reduces confusion, and increases confidence.

3

HIGH CONFIDENCE

Interviews, guards, and secondary research all pointed to the same gap: parents don’t know what’s happening on campus.

4

PRACTICAL & IMPLEMENTABLE

A digital kiosk is realistic, fundable, and easy to maintain.

FINAL IDEA: AD LIBS STATEMENT

OUR KIOSK
HELPS PARENTS VISITING IIIT H
WHO WANT TO QUICKLY UNDERSTAND
WHAT'S HAPPENING ON CAMPUS AND
NAVIGATE WITH CONFIDENCE
BY REDUCING CONFUSION ABOUT DIRECTIONS
AND LACK OF ACCESSIBLE INFORMATION
AND BY INCREASING THEIR AWARENESS OF
ONGOING EVENTS AND THEIR ABILITY TO
PARTICIPATE OR ENGAGE IF THEY WANT
UNLIKE THE COMPETING VALUE PROPOSITION
STATIC SIGNS OR DEPENDING ON
GUARDS/STUDENTS FOR INFO, WHICH ARE
INCOMPLETE AND NOT REAL-TIME.

IDEA VALIDATION

Validation with Guards

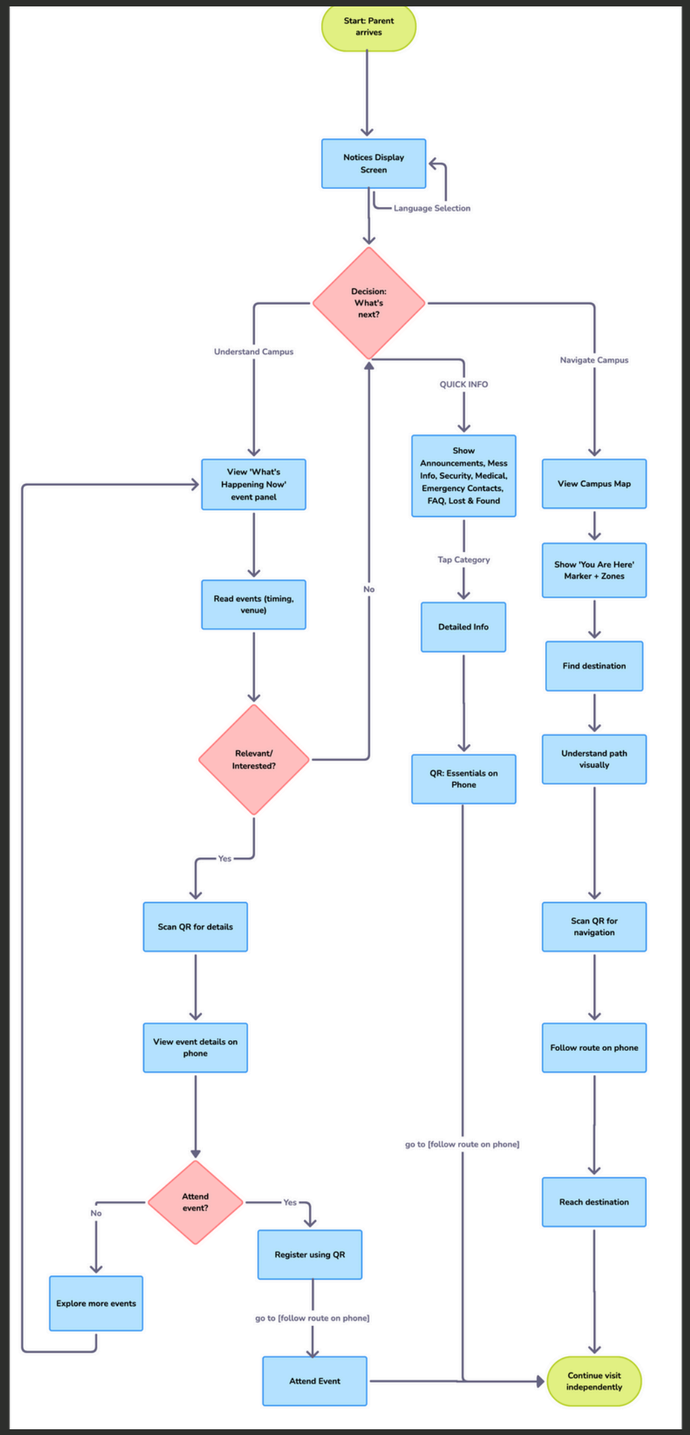
- Guards confirmed that around 10–15 parents visit the campus every day

Validation with Parents (Primary Users)

- Parents said they often feel unaware of events and would appreciate: event listings, navigation help, simple visual information.

Validation with Campus Facility Staff (Feasibility Check)

- They confirmed that installing a digital screen/kiosk is practical, fundable, and maintainable.

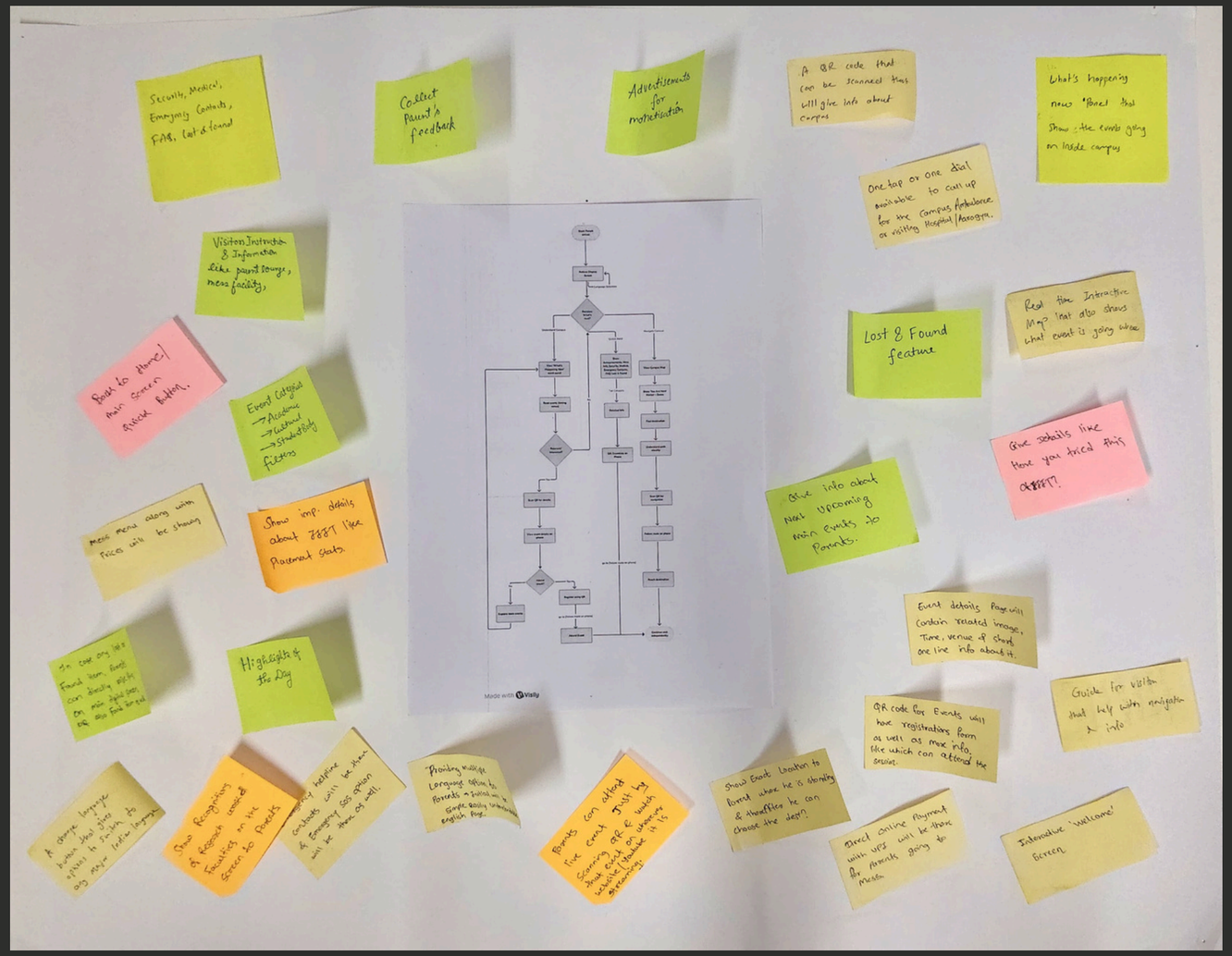


USER TASK ANLYSIS (LINK)

Using this flowchart, we focused on the two main tasks parents need to accomplish during their visit:

1. understanding what's happening on campus, and
2. navigating the campus with confidence.

BRAINSTORMING: FEATURES (LINK)



AFTER MAPPING OUT THE USER TASK ANALYSIS, WE USED IT TO BRAINSTORM ALL THE POSSIBLE FEATURES

FEATURE PRIORITISATION MATRIX

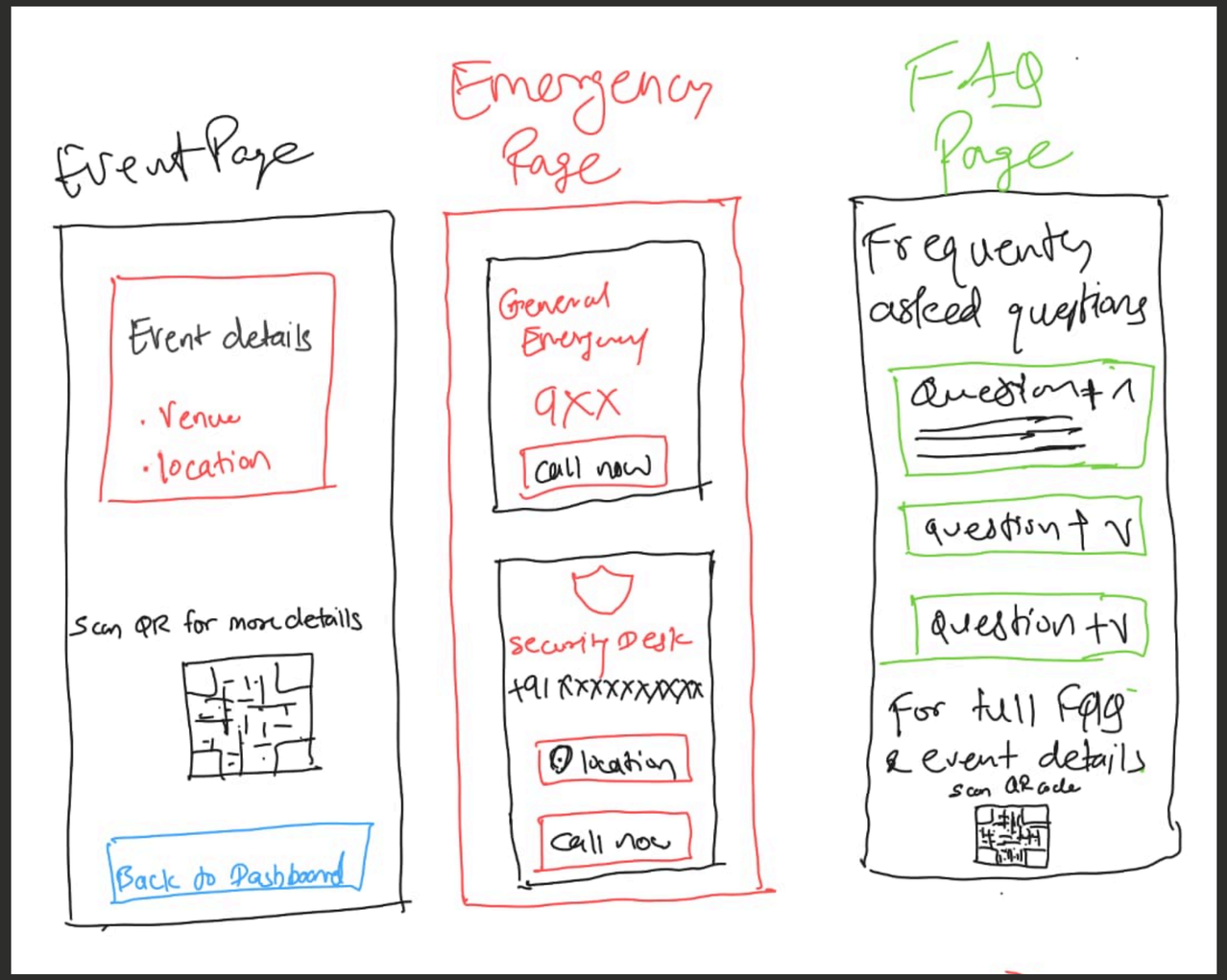
Feature	Impact	Ease	Frequency	Value	Feasibility	Priority
Real-time Event Updates	High	Medium	High	High	High	⭐ Top
Campus Map for Navigation	High	Medium	High	High	Medium	⭐ Top
Live Event Details	High	Medium	High	High	High	⭐ Top
Important Announcement	High	High	Medium	High	High	⭐ Top
QR for Event Registration	Medium	High	Medium	Medium	High	High
Mess Menu Display	Medium	High	Medium	Medium	High	High
Event Registration	Medium	Medium	Medium	High	Medium–High	High
Emergency Contacts	High	High	Low–Medium	High	High	High
Payment Option for	High	Medium	Medium	High	Medium	Medium–High
Visitor Kit (Emergency	Medium	High	Low–Medium	Medium	High	Medium–High
FAQ Section	Medium	High	Medium	Medium	High	Medium–High
Multi-Language Support	Medium	Medium	Medium	High	Medium	Medium
Lost & Found Info	Low–Medium	High	Low	Medium	High	Medium
Student Achievements	Low	High	Low	Low	High	Low

CRITERIA USED:

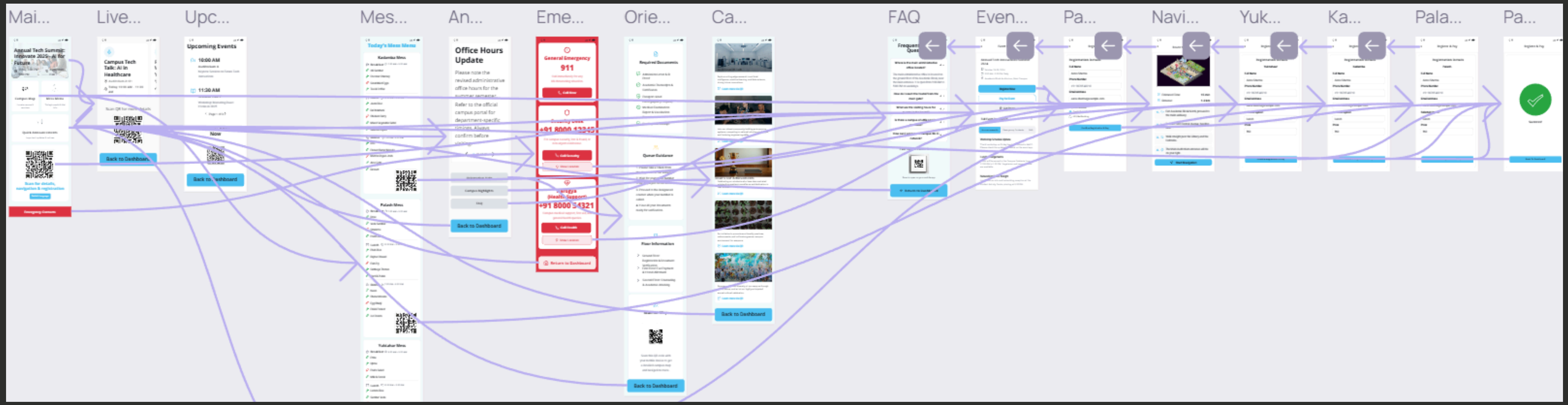
- IMPACT
- EASE OF IMPLEMENTATION
- FREQUENCY OF USE
- VALUE TO PARENTS
- FEASIBILITY FOR IIIT-H

FEATURE LIST

- LIVE EVENT DETAILS
- CAMPUS MAP FOR NAVIGATION
- MESS MENU
- QUICK ANNOUNCEMENTS
- MULTI LANGUAGE SUPPORT
- EMERGENCY CONTACTS
- EVENT REGESTRATION FORM
- PAYMENT OPTION FOR MESS AND PAID EVENTS

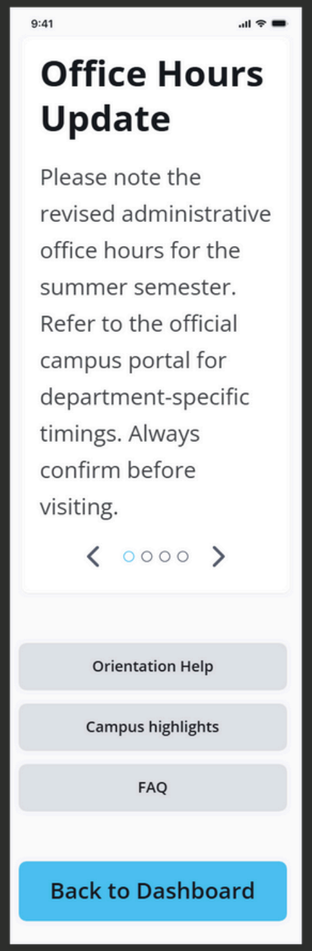


LOW FIDELITY DIAGRAM



WIREFRAMES (LINK)

HIGH FIDELITY DIAGRAM (LINK)



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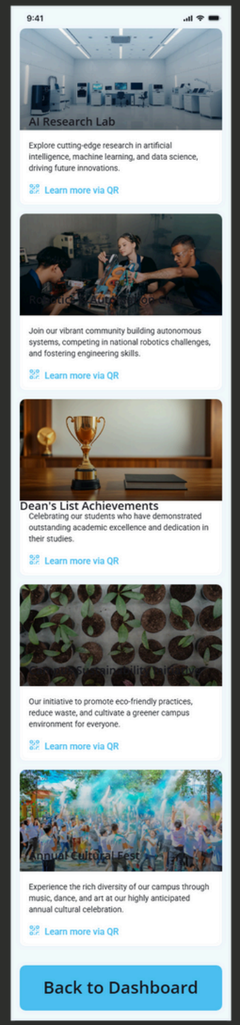

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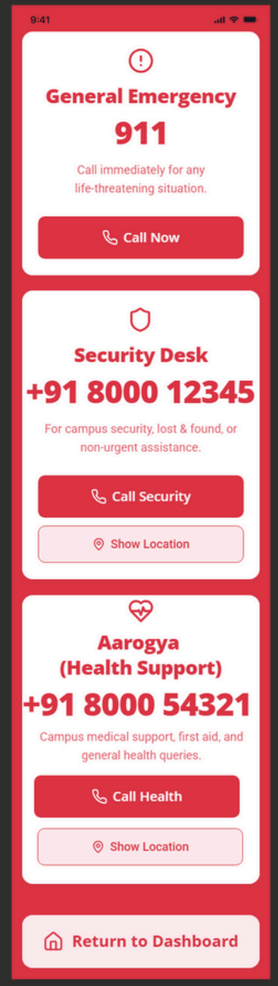

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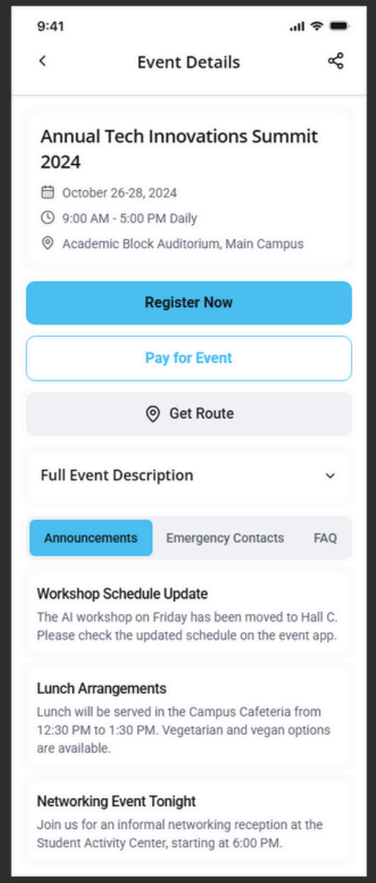

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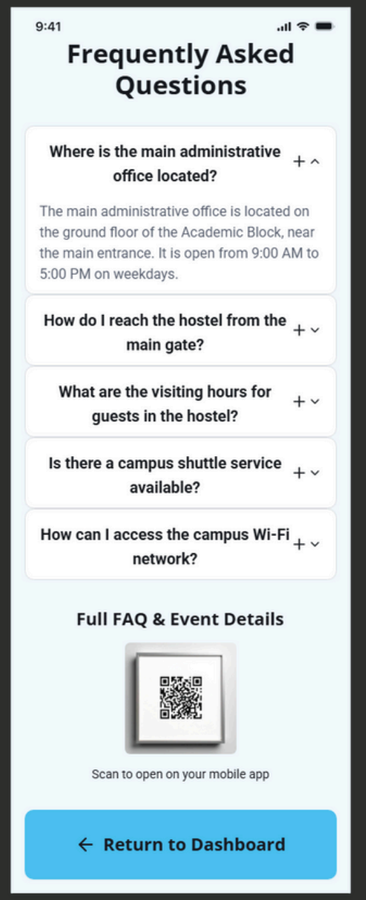

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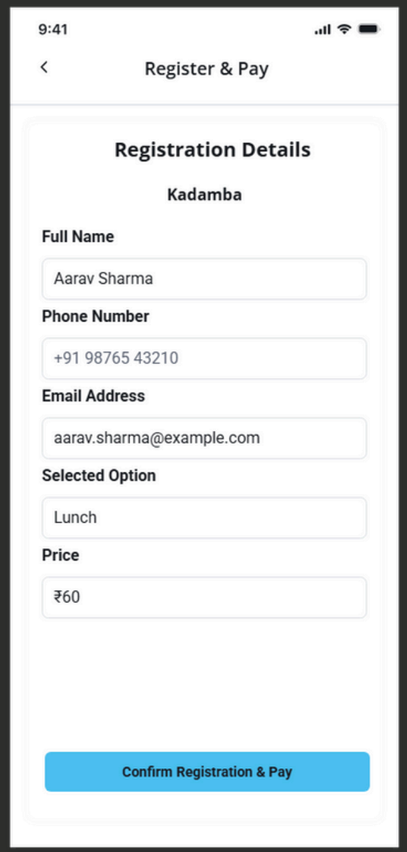

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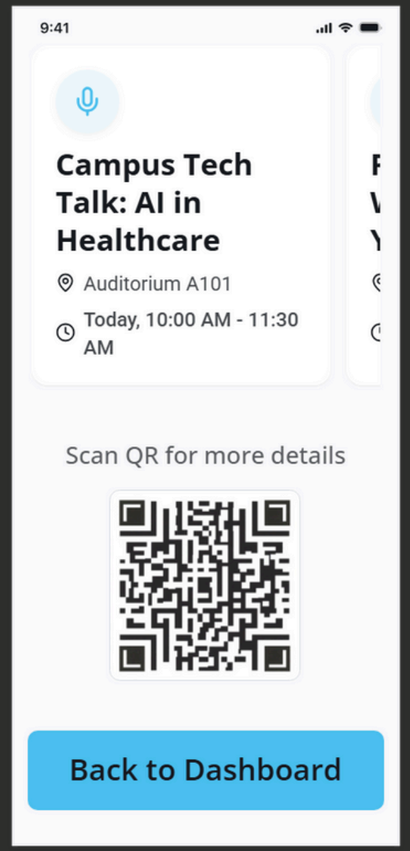
HIGH FIDELITY DIAGRAM



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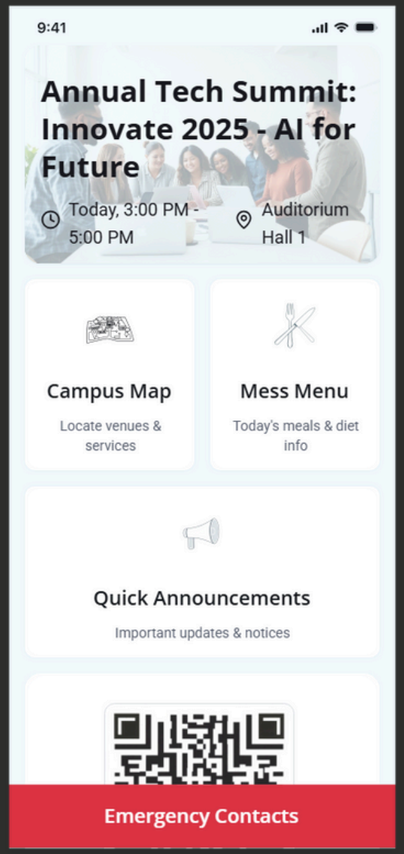

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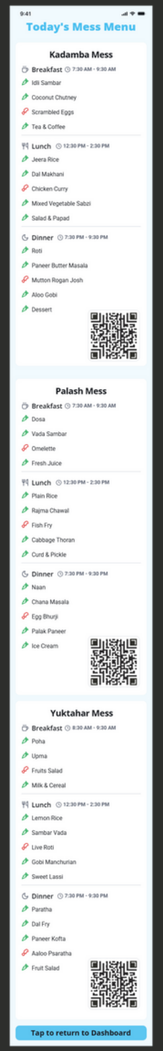

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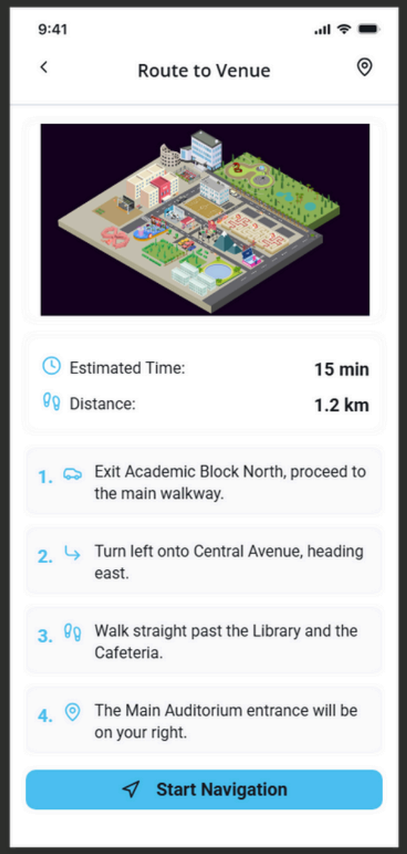

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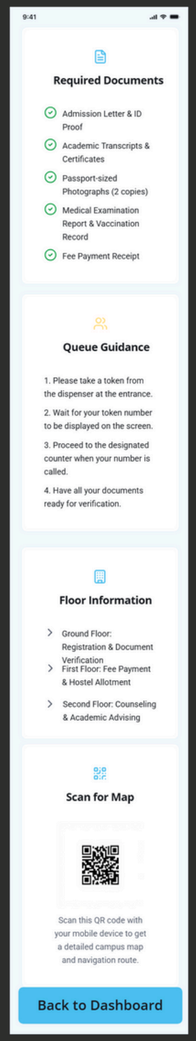

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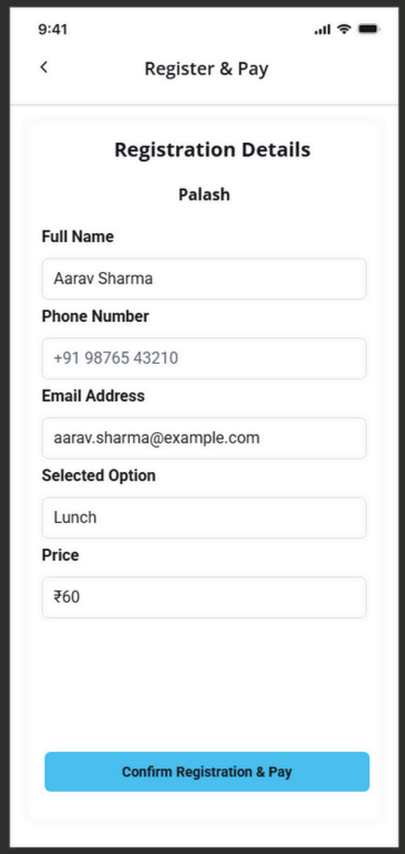

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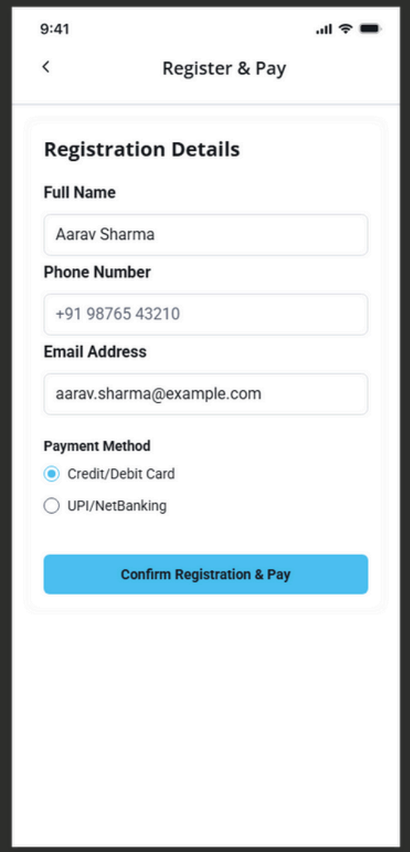

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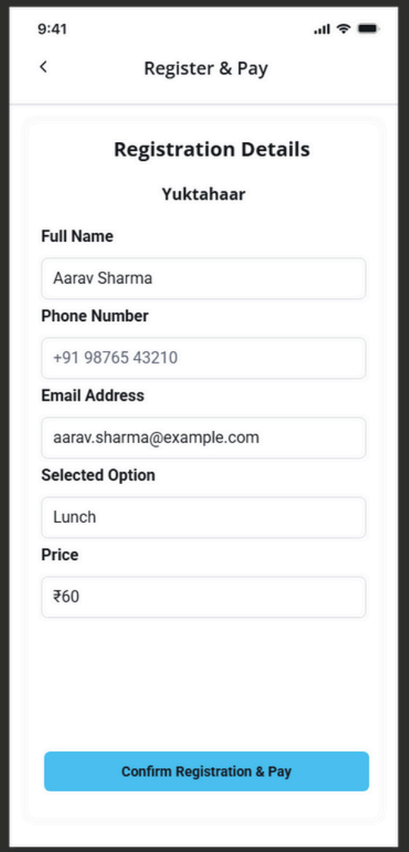

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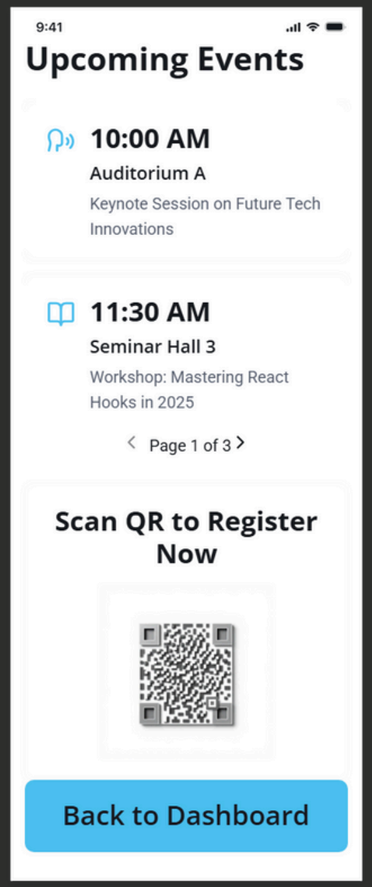

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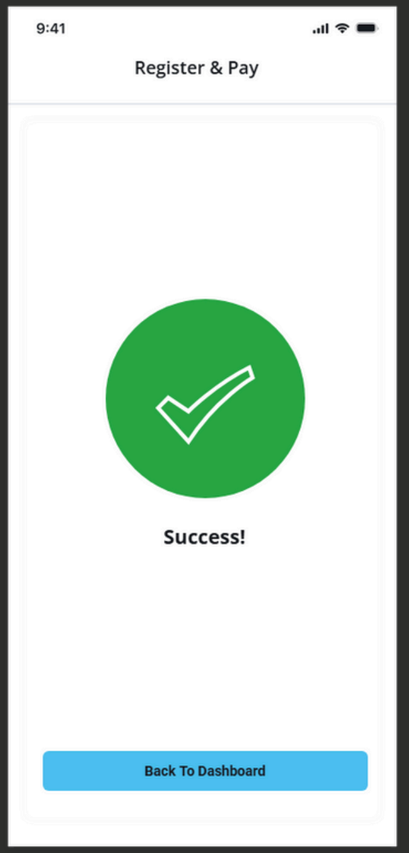

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PROTOTYPE TESTING

We tested our prototype with 2 parents by sharing the kiosk screens on video call and guiding them through how it would be used at the campus gate. They explored the events, map, mess menu, and QR flow. Their feedback confirmed that the kiosk makes information clearer, reduces dependence on guards, and helps parents navigate confidently.

INSIGHTS & RECOMMENDED CHANGES

Since parents were not physically at IIIT-H during testing, we explained the real context (kiosk at the gate, walking route, event hall).
Even with this constraint, parents could imagine the flow and said it would “definitely help on campus.
They said too much text would overwhelm them, and they appreciated the clean layout.

RECOMMENDATIONS-

- Include bilingual labels.
- Add a short usage hint on the home screen.

CONCLUSION

HOW OUR SOLUTION MEETS THE HMW

- Provides clear, real-time information the moment parents enter campus.
- Makes communication structured, simple, and accessible.
- Reduces confusion and dependence on guards/students.

HOW IT HELPS PARENTS

- Helps parents quickly understand what's happening.
- Enables easy, independent navigation.
- Makes them feel more connected and confident during their visit.

HOW IT IMPROVES IIIT-H VISITOR EXPERIENCE

- Creates a professional, unified visitor touchpoint.
- Reduces operational load on campus staff.
- Enhances IIIT-H's reputation for clarity, care, and organization.

THANK YOU !

TEAM IDEARC